

Arashk Afshar

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Public Economics, Political Economy, Microeconomic Theory

Secondary: Game Theory, Behavioral Economics

EDUCATION

Rutgers University, New Brunswick, NJ

Ph.D., Economics (expected March 2027)

M.A., Economics, 2023

Advisor and Dissertation Committee Chair: Oriol Carbonell-Nicolau

University of Washington Tacoma, Tacoma, WA

B.A., Business Administration (Finance), *Summa Cum Laude*, 2019

B.S., Mathematics, *Magna Cum Laude*, 2019

Green River College, Auburn, WA

A.A., Business, *Highest Honors*, 2016

JOB MARKET PAPER

Saving as a Luxury Good: Why Progressive Taxation Cannot Guarantee Falling Inequality

When the rich save a larger share of their wealth, no progressive tax guarantees that inequality falls over time. We show the classical characterizations hold within a period but not across periods, and that what governs the trajectory is a schedule's residual progression, a parameter every enacted and proposed wealth tax leaves untouched.

WORKING PAPERS

The Myth of the Informed Voter

Even fully informed voters can be decided by which issues a campaign makes salient rather than by what they know: money shapes elections through attention, not information. A binding spending cap forces competition across many issues at once, though whether it seats the broadly representative candidate depends on the structure of the electorate.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Saving as Instrument and Status: Progressive Taxation in a Dynamic Economy

Extends my job market paper to forward-looking agents, testing whether its non-convergence result depends on myopia. It does not. Anticipating the returns to accumulation, the wealthy save more aggressively still, and containing the divergence requires marginal-rate progressivity, a stricter standard than average-rate.

TEACHING

Instructor of record, Department of Economics, Rutgers University

- **Econ 440: Economics of Income Inequality and Discrimination.** Spring 2025, Spring 2026.
Designed the course and syllabus from a dormant catalog listing.
- **Econ 438: Education Economics.** Fall 2026. Designed the syllabus and introduced a project-based assessment.

- **Econ 402: Labor Economics.** Summer 2024, Summer 2025, Summer 2026. Designed the syllabus and introduced a project-based assessment.
- **Econ 320: Intermediate Microeconomic Analysis.** Summer 2023, Fall 2025, Spring 2026. Taught from a fully calculus-based treatment, including regular-semester sections of up to seventy-five.
- **College Writing 101,** Department of English. Fall 2024.

Teaching Fields: Public Economics and Taxation; Microeconomic Theory and Game Theory; Industrial Organization

TEACHING AWARD

Sidney I. Simon Award, 2024. For outstanding teaching by a graduate student, Department of Economics, Rutgers University.

OTHER ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

- Teaching Assistant, Rutgers University, 2021–2024
- Research Assistant, University of Washington Tacoma, 2018–2019
- Academic Tutor, University of Washington Tacoma, 2016–2020
- Academic Tutor, Green River College, 2014–2016

HONORS AND FELLOWSHIPS

- Nominated, President’s Medal, University of Washington Tacoma
- Interdisciplinary Award, for outstanding treatment of mathematics within other areas of study, University of Washington Tacoma
- *Pi Mu Epsilon* (mathematics), *Beta Gamma Sigma* (business), and *Phi Theta Kappa* honor societies
- Multiple merit scholarships, University of Washington Tacoma and Green River College (Milgard, Next Step, Dean’s, Floyd H. Miller Foundation, Shannon & Associates, Undergraduate Merit)

SOFTWARE

Python, R, Stata, MATLAB, $\text{\LaTeX}$

COMMUNITY SERVICE

- Volunteer Tax Preparer, United Way of King County
- Volunteer Tutor, University of Washington Tacoma and Green River College

LANGUAGES

English (fluent); Farsi (native)

REFERENCES

Oriol Carbonell-Nicolau (Advisor and Committee Chair)

Professor of Economics, Rutgers University · carbonell-nicolau@rutgers.edu

Richard P. McLean

Distinguished Professor of Economics, Rutgers University · rpmclean@economics.rutgers.edu

Andrew Mackenzie

Assistant Professor of Economics, Rutgers University · andrew.k.mackenzie@rutgers.edu